we have a chance to sit down.

73.

I RANG GRANNY on January 3.

We're coming back to Britain, I said. We'd love to see you.

I told her explicitly that we hoped to discuss with her our plan to create a different working arrangement.

She wasn't pleased. Neither was she shocked. She knew how unhappy we were, she'd seen this day on the horizon.

One good chat with my grandmother, I felt, would bring this ordeal to an end.

I said: *Granny, are you free?*

Yes, of course! I'm free all week. The diary is clear.

That's great. Meg and I can come up for tea and then drive back to London. We have an engagement at Canada House the next day.

You'll be exhausted from the travel. Do you want to stay here?

By "here" she meant Sandringham. Yes, that would be easier, and I told her so.

That would be lovely, thank you.

Are you planning to see your father too?

I asked, but he said it's impossible. He's in Scotland and can't leave until the end of the month.

She made a little sound. A sigh or a knowing grunt. I had to laugh.

She said: *I have only one thing to say about that.*

Yes?

Your father always does what he wants to do.

Days later, January 5, as Meg and I boarded a flight in Vancouver, I got a frantic note from our staff, who'd received a frantic note from the Bee. Granny wouldn't be able to see me. *Initially Her Majesty thought this would be possible, it will not…The Duke of Sussex cannot come to Norfolk tomorrow. Her*